It had sunk to the very depths of misery and illustrated all the
I evils of the subsidiary state system.
In May, 1857, the Indian army at Meerut mutinied. The
I revolt had been secretly and well organized but a premature
[outburst rather upset the plans of the leaders. It was much
more than a military mutiny and it spread rapidly and assumed
the character of a popular rebellion and a war of Indian indepen-
dence. As such a popular rebellion of the masses it was confined
I to Delhi, the United Provinces (as they are now called), and parts
I of central India and Bihar. Essentially it was a feudal outburst,
[headed by feudal chiefs and their followers and aided by the
[widespread anti-foreign sentiment. Inevitably it looked up to
[the relic of the Mughal dynasty, still sitting in the Delhi palace,
I but feeble and old and powerless. Both Hindus and Moslems took
1 full part in the Revolt.
This Revolt strained British rule to the utmost and it was u l t -
imately suppressed with Indian help. It brought out all the
linherent weaknesses of the old regime, which was making its
[last despairing effort to drive out foreign rule. The feudal chiefs
Ihad the sympathy of the masses over large areas, but they were